

Regular Expressions

Regular expressions is a general term which covers the idea of pattern searching, typically in a string (or a vector of strings).

For now we'll learn about two useful functions for regular expressions and pattern searching (we'll go deeper into this topic in general later on):

- `grepl()`, which returns a logical indicating if the pattern was found
- `grep()`, which returns a vector of index locations of matching pattern instances

For both of these functions you'll pass in a pattern and then the object you want to search. Let's see some quick examples:

In [1]:

```
text <- "Hi there, do you know who you are voting for?"
```

In [4]:

```
grepl('voting',text)
```

Out[4]:

TRUE

In [5]:

```
grepl('Hi',text)
```

Out[5]:

TRUE

In [6]:

```
grepl('Sammy',text)
```

Out[6]:

FALSE

In [8]:

```
v <- c('a','b','c','d')
```

In [9]:

```
grep('a',v)
```

Out[9]:

1

In [10]:

```
grep('c',v)
```

Out[10]:

We'll learn more regular expression functions as we need them when doing exercises or projects. Want more info on regular expressions with R in the meantime? Check out this [link](#)